

above tepee status, and there are modern versions that you can use in all climates, however extreme. They aren't all pitch dark and made out of goat hair, either. We're talking French doors, roll up walls, lots of windows, insulated enough to work in extreme northern climates or open enough to be plunked in the tropics. I've seen them with baby grand pianos, full bathrooms, fireplaces, full kitchens, Internet, electricity—the works. The Cadillac versions might run closer to \$25,000, but there are many ways to get started for much less than that. This would enable you to pay it off very quickly and start saving for a home. These structures leave a very low ecological footprint as well. Many people choose to live in them permanently, while others use them after the home is up as a studio or guest house. A bonus is you can pack the whole darn thing up and ship it to another location if you find things aren't working out well for you where you are. You'll just need to find a new parking spot for your home.

### 7. Consider a Quonset hut

These will cost you a bit more than an actual yurt, and they are far from a traditional form of housing. That being said, I have seen them done on the

interior in a style that those comfortable with the loft look could probably go for. You could also consider it a place to have an apartment in a loft section of the building and a garage underneath. Then you could plan to have this as a garage with a rental once a larger structure went up. Although, some people dig these things enough to make them their permanent home.

### 8. Stay in a shipping container

There has been much talk on the news lately about using these things to create alternative, eco-friendly housing. Some of them, however, cost closer to half a million dollars. If that is your budget, good for you. If not, there are much more affordable ideas out there that even include a shaded carport.

### 9. Part-time caretaking

There are many options available for this. Searching the newspapers in your area for people in need of a little handyman work in exchange for rent is a place to start. International house-sitting organizations are another. In addition to the house-sitting option listed first, many places need people to tend their lodge or working guest-house while they travel abroad or tend to family issues. There are even people who love their remote larger estates yet